

**A GRAND STRATEGY METHODOLOGY**

*For anyone who wants better outcomes with AI*

# SCRIPT™



*A Practical, Emotionally Intelligent  
Method for Prompting AI Well*

**GRAND STRATEGY CONSULTING**

SITUATION • CLEAR INTENT • ROLE • INSTRUCTIONS • PARAMETERS • TEST

[www.grandstrategy.llc](http://www.grandstrategy.llc)

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## **Introduction: Prompting Is a Practice**

Most people treat prompting in a Frontier AI chatbot as a lottery: type something, hope, regenerate, hope again. That approach is fine for a haiku. It fails the moment the output carries stakes; for example, a board memo, a client deliverable, a message to a team under pressure.

SCRIPT™ was developed by Grand Strategy Consulting as our prompt engineering approach to closing that gap. It is a six-step methodology that treats a prompt not as a simple sentence command you fire off, but as a small act of communication design: you establish the situation, declare your intent, assign a role, give instructions, set parameters, and critically test the result against what you actually meant to achieve.

### **WHERE EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE COMES IN**

SCRIPT™ is grounded in the ability model of emotional intelligence measured by the MSCEIT®2 assessment administered by Multi-Health Systems Inc. Before you can direct a Frontier AI chatbot well, you have to perceive what you are feeling about the task, connect those emotions to your thinking, understand what outcome you actually need, and manage your response when the first draft disappoints. The Clear Intent step, in particular, asks you to connect emotions to thinking: how do you want your audience to feel, and what do you want them to do?

An intent you cannot articulate is an intent your Frontier AI model cannot service.

## **AN HONEST WORD ABOUT WHAT SCRIPT IS**

SCRIPT™ belongs to a family of structured prompt engineering frameworks. The structure itself is not new.

Structured prompt frameworks are a crowded, well-established space. SCRIPT's components: role assignment, context-setting, explicit instructions, constraints closely mirror existing frameworks like CO-STAR, RTF, CRISPE, RISEN, and the prompting guidance published by Anthropic, Google, and OpenAI themselves.

The underlying mechanism (structured context produces better outputs than ad hoc prompts) is settled practice.

What SCRIPT™ adds is a complete practice: it is the framework that begins with intent and ends with testing.

The two steps most approaches skip.

We make no inflated claims about SCRIPT™ producing categorically superior outputs. What we can claim is something more useful. A method you can repeat, teach, and trust when you want to create a discipline that keeps the 'human in the lead'.

## The SCRIPT™ Framework at a Glance

Six steps, in a deliberate order: context and purpose come before instructions, and every prompt ends with verification.

|          | Step         | The question it answers                                                            |
|----------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>S</b> | Situation    | What context does the AI model need that it cannot see?                            |
| <b>C</b> | Clear Intent | What should be different in the world after this output is used?                   |
| <b>R</b> | Role         | Whose expertise and voice should the AI model adopt?                               |
| <b>I</b> | Instructions | What exactly should be produced, and in what order?                                |
| <b>P</b> | Parameters   | What boundaries (format, tone, ethics) must the output respect?                    |
| <b>T</b> | Test         | Does the output achieve the declared intent? If not, what changes need to be made? |

*A prompt that works once is luck. A prompt that survives testing is a process.*

## S: Situation

State the context the AI model cannot see: the background, the circumstances, what has happened so far, and any constraints of the environment. An AI model fills every gap you leave with a guess. It's guesses not your judgement become your output.

### ASK YOURSELF

- What is going on that makes this request necessary?
- Who is involved, and what has already been tried or decided?
- What would a capable colleague need to know before starting?

### FROM WEAK TO STRONG

**Weak:** *Write an email to my team.*

**Strong:** *Our team of twelve just learned a project deadline moved up three weeks. Morale is shaky after two earlier scope changes this quarter.*

## C: Clear Intent

Declare the purpose: the outcome you want the output to achieve in the world, not just the artifact you want produced. This is the step where emotional intelligence does its heaviest lifting: you are connecting emotions to thinking, naming how you want your audience to feel and what you want them to do as a result.

Intent is also your evaluation standard. If you cannot state the intent, you cannot judge the output and neither can the AI model.

### ASK YOURSELF

- What should be different after this output is used?
- How do you want the reader or audience to feel and respond?
- What would make you say, honestly, that this worked?

### FROM WEAK TO STRONG

**Weak:** *Make it professional.*

**Strong:** *I want the team to leave this email feeling the deadline is achievable and that leadership has a plan not panicked or blindsided.*



## R: Role

Assign the AI model a role or perspective suited to the task. The role shapes vocabulary, assumptions, and judgment. Keep it functional, not theatrical: specific professional experience adds value; flattering superlatives add nothing.

### ASK YOURSELF

- Who would you hire to do this task, if a person were doing it?
- What expertise, voice, or vantage point should the AI model adopt?

### FROM WEAK TO STRONG

**Weak:** *You are a world-class genius writer.*

**Strong:** *Act as an experienced change-management communicator who has guided teams through compressed timelines.*

## I: Instructions

Give the specific task, stated as actions. Break multi-part work into numbered steps, in the order and with the emphasis you want. Instructions answer the 'what'; intent answers the 'why'.

### ASK YOURSELF

- What exactly should the AI model produce or do?
- In what order, and with what emphasis?
- Can the task be broken into numbered steps?

### FROM WEAK TO STRONG

**Weak:** *Write something about the deadline change.*

**Strong:** *Draft the email in three parts: (1) acknowledge the change honestly, (2) outline the adjusted plan in three bullets, (3) close with a concrete next step and an invitation for questions.*

## P: Parameters

Set the boundaries: format, length, tone, audience, exclusions, and any constraints the output must respect. Parameters are also where your ethics live, i.e. privacy floors, no fabricated data, no claims you cannot support. Build them in every time, not only when someone remembers.

### ASK YOURSELF

- What length, structure, and format does the output require?
- What tone and reading level fit the audience?
- What must be excluded? Confidential details, jargon, speculation?
- What ethical boundaries apply? Privacy, accuracy, honest claims?

### FROM WEAK TO STRONG

**Weak:** *Keep it short.*

**Strong:** *Under 250 words. Plain language, no corporate jargon. Do not mention the client by name. Do not promise resources we have not secured.*

## T: Test

Evaluate the output against the Clear Intent not against whether it merely looks good. Testing is where most real-world quality comes from, and it is the step nearly every other framework omits.

Testing is not regenerating. Rerunning the same prompt hoping for a better draw is a lottery ticket. Testing means diagnosing the specific gap; the tone, missing content, wrong emphasis, and revising the relevant SCRIPT element, usually Situation, Intent, or Parameters rather than the wording of the Instructions.

### ASK YOURSELF

- Re-read the intent statement from step C.
- Does this output achieve that intent, for that audience?
- Where exactly is the gap: tone, content, emphasis, or format?
- Which SCRIPT element needs to change before the next run?

Repeat until the output passes the intent check. Then, and only then, is the prompt done.

## A Worked Example

An education client's employee survey closes Friday. Participation sits at 41 percent; last year it reached 78. The CEO wants to send one final reminder. Here is the full SCRIPT:

***Situation:*** Our employee survey closes Friday. Participation is at 41%; last year we reached 78%. Staff are stretched and wary of being chased.

***Clear Intent:*** I want staff to feel their voice genuinely matters and to complete the survey today not to feel nagged or surveilled.

***Role:*** Act as an internal communications specialist experienced in an education workforce engagement.

***Instructions:*** Draft the CEO's reminder email. Open with what last year's feedback changed, then make the ask, then state the deadline.

***Parameters:*** Under 150 words. Warm, first-person CEO voice. Reaffirm anonymity. No guilt language, no participation statistics.

***Test:*** Read the draft as a skeptical employee. Does this feel like an invitation or a chase? If a chase, revise the tone parameters and rerun.

Notice what the Test step does: it turns the intent statement into a standard. The prompt is not finished when the email is drafted; it is finished when a skeptical reader would experience it as an invitation.

## Common Mistakes

- **Skipping Situation** because “the AI model will figure it out.” It will, but by guessing, and its guesses become your unverified output.
- **Confusing Instructions with Intent.** “Write a summary” is an instruction. “Help the board approve the budget without a second meeting” is intent. You need both.
- **Over-costuming the Role.** “You are a world-renowned genius” adds nothing. Specific professional experience does.
- **Treating Test as regenerate.** Hoping for a better draw is not testing. Testing diagnoses the gap against intent and changes the relevant element.
- **Parameters as an afterthought.** Ethical and compliance boundaries belong in every prompt, not only the ones someone remembers to protect.

## When SCRIPT Is Overkill

For quick, low-stakes, one-off requests, such as five title options or a first brainstorm, a lighter touch is fine. SCRIPT earns its keep when the output carries stakes, will be reused, will be seen by clients or leadership, or must be taught to others as a repeatable practice.

A framework that claims to be right for everything ends up trusted for nothing. Use SCRIPT where it matters; skip it where it does not.

# The Ethics of Prompting

Working with an AI model ethically is not a separate discipline bolted onto prompting. It is built into the method. Three commitments run through SCRIPT:

- **Honesty in Parameters.** Every prompt carries your boundaries: protect privacy, exclude confidential details, refuse fabricated data and unsupported claims.
- **Honesty in Testing.** Test asks whether the output is true to your intent, and whether the intent itself is one you would defend out loud.
- **Honesty in claims about the method.** SCRIPT is a complete, teachable practice, distinctive for beginning with intent and ending with testing. It is not a magic multiplier.
- **Humans stay in the lead.** A principle we credit to Angela Pitter of LiveWire Collaborative. SCRIPT exists to keep the person, their emotions, their intent, and their ethics at the front of every exchange with a machine.



## About Grand Strategy Consulting

Grand Strategy Consulting LLC is a human-centered AI and emotional intelligence consultancy, powering logic with EI and AI. We bridge the gap between artificial intelligence and emotional intelligence through learning circles, solution architecture, change management, certifications, and coaching.

Our proprietary approaches include Emotional Maths®, SUMMS™, and the SCRIPT™ prompt methodology. Zena Collins, co-founder and creator of Emotional Maths®, is a Certified Master Trainer in the MSCEIT®2, working in partnership with the assessment's co-creator, Dr. David R. Caruso and the creators of the Six Dimensions of Healthy Work Environments Armela Toro Waters and Dr. David R. Caruso.

### GO FURTHER

- **Read the book:** [Stop Wasting Time With AI: The Emotional Maths® Method, available on Amazon.](#)
- **Work with us:** learning circles, workshops, and AI workflow solutions at [www.grandstrategy.llc](http://www.grandstrategy.llc).
- **Teach SCRIPT:** share this guide with attribution, and keep the claims as honest as the method.